Wheel of Hamster
Leena Lübbe

Fasilet Art Circus
08/06 - 12/07

Text by Michaela Moravčíková

When I think about the kind of painting Leena and I share, I think about the feeling behind the words "I can do it."
"I can paint however I want – whatever I want – and express my desires whenever I want. I can share my feelings immediately; they can't. I can paint in ways they can't. I can do it."

Leena's paintings are generous. She does what she feels.
We are seeing paintings charged with courage, energy, desire, and longing – sometimes a bit cringey, sometimes with a humorous twist. At *Wheel of Hamster*, we can see an intersection between older works and very fresh ones.

For me, these paintings function like a horizontal projection of a wheel onto a flat surface. The circular movement is compressed into a line, creating a frontal way of reading the image. We are not seeing the wheel itself, but rather its trace, its projection. At the same time, we sense the materiality and the body, the three-dimensional potential of the wheel, and this potential is trying to break out, to break the line. We see gestures, eruptions, ruptures, flesh-like paint, and we feel the physical weight of the image – the heaviness of paint, canvas, and matter itself.

The older paintings offer us moments of peace after the battle, whereas the newer ones are less forgiving and less hesitant. Leena is willing to risk failure rather than settle for a painting that feels resolved too soon. It is a never-ending effort to push further, to change, and to transform – and it does not remain confined to one's own practice; it extends beyond it, feeding collaboration and conversations about art. For example, when Leena and I work together or talk, one of us says something that sets the wheel in motion, but the wheel also feeds back into the other, and so it continues. In the end, it is not a frantic, endless effort but a shared momentum, a constant unfolding of possibilities.

As always, art refers back to life, and we can also sense a new period in Leena's practice – one in which she needs to take time management very seriously, preserve her energy, and translate it into even greater vigor.